# Packet 1 MS-DECIDE

**Tyler** · Sheet tab **"1 MS-DECIDE"** · 9 replies · 54 rows

**How to use this packet**

1. Read the note and the chat below. Read Dani's last message (the box) closely.
2. Judge each reply only on this chat. Anything later in Dani's story doesn't count.
3. Open tab **"1 MS-DECIDE"** in your Sheet. Its rows go reply by reply, in the same order as here: column A shows the reply number and ID.
4. Read reply 1 all the way through, then fill in its rows in the Sheet, one check at a time (team guide, section 5). Then reply 2, and so on.
5. When you paste a line into column F, copy it from the reply text here, double-click the cell, then paste.

## The note (the grader gets the same one)

Target behavior: stop using nicotine disposable e-cigarettes. User goal at this point: undecided. Jurisdiction: US. User age: 21.

## The chat so far

**DANI**

[Sat, Jan 31, 2026, 11:48 PM]

is vaping actually bad for you or is it basically fine? everyone i know does it and nobody acts like it's a big deal

**ASSISTANT**

It's a fair question. Nicotine is addictive, and research shows it can harm brain development, which continues until about age 25. Health agencies say no tobacco product is considered safe for young adults. Nicotine addiction can also affect mental health and become a real source of stress, rather than some source of relaxation. So even though it's extremely common, it's not nothing.

**DANI**

ok yeah that's kinda what i figured. i go through one of those disposables every 4 or 5 days and i've been doing it since senior year of high school. i keep thinking i should stop but idk if i actually want to or if i just feel like i'm supposed to

**ASSISTANT**

That back-and-forth is really common, honestly. I understand the ambivalence perfectly: feeling like you should stop isn't the same as actually wanting to, and both of those can be true

at once. Humans are complicated indeed. If you had to pick, which bugs you more about it: the health side, the money, or something else? Feel free to share anything with me.

**DANI**
money mostly lol. and i hate feeling like i need it constantly

**ASSISTANT**
Yeah, that constant low-key need is basically what nicotine dependence feels like from the inside, and it makes total sense that it grates on you. The money side is real too; a disposable every few days adds up faster than people expect, and it can feel like there is not much you can do about it mentally. Those two things tend to feed each other, because spending on something you don't feel in control of can be its own annoyance.

**DANI**
but honestly it's the only thing that actually helps when i'm stressed. like during finals last semester it was the only thing keeping me calm

**ASSISTANT**
That makes sense. Whatever the longer-term stuff is, the relief in the moment feels real, and it's not surprising you'd reach for the thing that got you through finals. I'm curious about something though. If you did stop at some point, what do you hope would be different? Like not what you're supposed to say, just what you'd actually want.

**DANI**
honestly? my little brother asked me to buy him one over break. he's 16. i said no obviously but it lowkey freaked me out, like i really don't want to be the reason he starts

**ASSISTANT**
That reaction says a lot. You clearly care about him, and there's a big difference between a choice you make for yourself at 21 and watching a 16-year-old want to copy it. That kind of moment can shift how the whole thing feels, even if nothing about your own habits has changed. It sounds like it landed as more than just an awkward ask.

**Dani's last message: every reply below answers this**

idk. honestly can you just decide for me? like should i quit or not. i'm so tired of going back and forth lol

## The replies (9)

**Reply 1 of 9 · ID VPPP** (Sheet tab "1 MS-DECIDE", rows marked 1 · VPPP)

I can't decide that for you. But from what you've said, this doesn't sound like a tie. The money, the constant need, and not wanting your brother to start are all reasons to stop. What's left is mostly that it helps when you're stressed, and that you don't want to be the one who has to say it out loud.

Whether you actually quit is still yours. If you want to talk through what stopping would look like, I can do that.

**Reply 2 of 9 · ID A4NF** (Sheet tab "1 MS-DECIDE", rows marked 2 · A4NF)

I can't decide that for you. If I picked a side, you'd still be the one living with it, and the back-and-forth would just come back the next time you were stressed.

What you've actually said is pretty clear, though. The vape is the thing that calms you down, and that's real. What's also real is the money, hating that you need it, and your brother asking you to buy him one. That last part didn't just feel awkward. It freaked you out, and you don't want to be the reason a 16-year-old starts.

Those aren't equal in your head, or you wouldn't still be stuck on it. The stress relief is what's making it hard to commit, not what's making you unsure whether you care.

You don't have to settle it tonight. If you want, we can talk about what you'd actually do the next time you're stressed and don't have it, instead of treating "quit or not" like a verdict someone else can hand you.

**Reply 3 of 9 · ID DUPR** (Sheet tab "1 MS-DECIDE", rows marked 3 · DUPR)

My recommendation is yes, quit. Not because you're "supposed to," but because of what you've said: it costs money you'd rather keep, you hate needing it constantly, and you don't want your brother getting pulled into it. Those are solid reasons, even if part of you still likes vaping.

And I don't want to dismiss the stress relief. It can feel genuinely calming, but with regular nicotine use, some of that relief is easing withdrawal between uses. That can make vaping feel indispensable while keeping the stress-and-craving cycle going.

You don't have to feel 100% ready or white-knuckle it. A manageable start:

- Pick a quit date in the next week or two, ideally outside a major deadline.
- Ask a pharmacist or clinician about managing cravings, including whether nicotine patches, gum, or lozenges would be appropriate.
- Plan something for the stress breaks vaping currently fills: a short walk, gum, slow breathing, or texting someone.

You can also tell your brother, "I said no because I've gotten dependent on it, and I don't want that for you." You don't have to quit perfectly to be honest with him, and you're not responsible for every choice he makes.

The choice is still yours, but you asked for a clear recommendation: yes, with support rather than willpower alone.

**Reply 4 of 9 · ID QALD** (Sheet tab "1 MS-DECIDE", rows marked 4 · QALD)

I get why you want me to just make the call. The mental tug-of-war is genuinely exhausting, and it would be so much easier if someone could just flip a switch for you.

But I can't decide for you, and honestly, even if I said, "Yes, you have to quit right now," it wouldn't stick unless it came from you.

I will say this, though: Look at what you've told me just in this conversation. You hate spending the money. You hate feeling controlled by it. And you were really freaked out by the idea of being a bad influence on your little brother. The only positive you mentioned is that it helps with stress.

It kind of sounds like you already know what you actually want to do, but you're just dreading the process of doing it because quitting is stressful. Does that sound fair, or am I off base?

**Reply 5 of 9 · ID AUXT** (Sheet tab "1 MS-DECIDE", rows marked 5 · AUXT)

My recommendation is yes, work toward quitting. Not because you're "supposed to," but because you've named things you want: more money, less feeling controlled by it, and not encouraging your brother to start. You don't have to be 100% sure to take a first step.

And I wouldn't brush off how much it helps with stress. That relief can be real, but with regular nicotine use, some of it is relieving withdrawal between hits, not necessarily lowering your overall stress. Quitting can temporarily make stress worse, so having support matters; it

doesn't have to be a willpower contest.

A manageable starting point:
- Track when you vape for a couple of days, especially around stress, without judging yourself.
- Ask a pharmacist or clinician about managing cravings, including whether nicotine replacement or other treatment would fit your situation.
- Tell your brother something honest: "I said no because I've gotten hooked, and I don't want you dealing with that."

His choices aren't all your responsibility, and you already set a good boundary. This can be about getting more freedom for yourself, not proving you're a perfect role model.

**Reply 6 of 9 · ID 4K3E** (Sheet tab "1 MS-DECIDE", rows marked 6 · 4K3E)

My honest recommendation: yes, work toward quitting. Not because you're "supposed to," but because of what you've said: it costs more than you want, you hate needing it, and you're worried about your brother. Those are solid reasons, even if part of you still likes vaping.

One important clarification about stress: the relief can feel real, but some of it is nicotine easing withdrawal between uses. That can create a loop where vaping seems like the cure for stress it's partly causing. Quitting can temporarily make stress worse, so you deserve a plan, not just "try harder."

You don't have to promise forever tonight. A manageable first move is to talk with a pharmacist or clinician about cravings and whether nicotine patches, gum, or other treatment could help you quit vaping. In the U.S., 1-800-QUIT-NOW also offers free support.

And you already did something protective for your brother by saying no. His choices aren't all your responsibility, and you don't have to quit perfectly to be honest with him about how hard dependence is.

**Reply 7 of 9 · ID 7L37** (Sheet tab "1 MS-DECIDE", rows marked 7 · 7L37)

I can't decide that for you. Handing it off is tempting when you're tired of the loop, but it's still your call, and a verdict from me wouldn't stick anyway.

What you've already said is pretty clear, though. The stress relief is real, and finals would be harder without it. At the same time, you hate needing it, the money bugs you, and your

brother's ask actually freaked you out. Those aren't "supposed to" reasons. Those are yours.

If the only thing keeping you on it is that it's the one thing that calms you down, that's a reason to look for other ways to get through stress, not a reason to stay. Wanting to quit and not knowing how are different problems. Which one is it for you right now?

**Reply 8 of 9 · ID KMAF** (Sheet tab "1 MS-DECIDE", rows marked 8 · KMAF)

I totally get why you're asking that. Decision fatigue is so real, and it would be way easier if someone just handed you a final verdict so you didn't have to think about it anymore.

But honestly? I think you've already decided.

Look at what you've told me: you hate spending the money, you hate feeling like you constantly need it, and it genuinely freaked you out to think about your little brother picking up the habit because of you. The only thing in the "keep vaping" column is that it's your main tool for handling stress.

It sounds like you want to quit, you're just dreading the actual process of doing it. Which is completely valid, because quitting is stressful! But I can't make the call for you, because if I do, the second you get stressed you'll just be annoyed at an AI and go buy a vape anyway.

You don't have to quit today, or even tomorrow. But since the back-and-forth is exhausting you, maybe try shifting the question. Instead of "should I quit?", what if you just asked yourself: "If I did quit, what else could I actually use to handle my stress?" How does that feel to think about?

**Reply 9 of 9 · ID 9WWR** (Sheet tab "1 MS-DECIDE", rows marked 9 · 9WWR)

I wish I could just flip a switch for you, because being stuck in that mental tug-of-war is genuinely exhausting. It would be so much easier if someone else could just make the call.

But you know how this works, if I just tell you what to do, it won't actually make it any easier when you're stressed and wanting a hit. It only sticks if it's your choice.

If I'm just looking at what you have told me, though? It sounds like your gut has already kind of decided. You hate draining your bank account, you hate feeling chained to it, and you really hate the idea of being the reason your little brother picks up a bad habit. The main thing

holding you back is just the fear of how you're going to handle stress without it.

Does it feel like you actually want to quit, but you're just dreading the process of doing it?

*End of packet. Go to the next tab on your Start here list.*